NORTHLINE SYSTEMS
IT Security Policy
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Document owner: Information Security
Classification: Internal

1. Purpose
This policy sets minimum security requirements for Northline Systems systems, accounts, and devices.

2. Accounts and authentication
Every employee receives a unique directory account. Sharing passwords is prohibited. Passwords must be at least 12 characters and must not reuse the last 8 passwords. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is required for email, VPN, cloud consoles, and the People Portal.

3. Devices
Company laptops must keep disk encryption enabled. Operating system and browser updates must be installed within 7 days of release for critical patches. Personal devices may access mail only through the approved mobile management profile.

4. Removable media
USB storage and other removable media are prohibited unless Information Security issues a written exception for a named project. Exceptions expire after 90 days.

5. Data classification
Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted labels apply. Confidential and Restricted data must not be stored in personal cloud accounts. Restricted data, including customer production credentials, may only be stored in the approved secrets manager.

6. Remote access
VPN is required when accessing internal services from outside Northline offices. Split-tunnel VPN is disabled. Unattended sessions must lock after 10 minutes.

7. Incident reporting
Suspected phishing, malware, or lost devices must be reported to security@northline.example within 1 hour of discovery. Employees must not pay ransomware demands.

8. Software
Only software from the approved catalogue may be installed. Open-source tools need a lightweight review by IT if they are not already listed. Browser extensions that read page content are not allowed.

9. Access reviews
Managers review application access quarterly. Access that is unused for 60 days is removed automatically for non-critical systems.